

Vorticism

Aiming to create art and poetry that expressed the dynamism of the modern world, the British Vorticist movement combined Cubist fragmentation with geometric imagery that derived from machines and the urban environment and bordered on abstraction. The group was founded in 1914 by Wyndham Lewis (1882–1957), but ended the following year. It held one exhibition and produced two issues of the magazine *BLAST*, containing their manifesto and deriding what Lewis saw as the flimsiness of British art and culture. Vorticists included Lawrence Atkinson (1873–1931), Jessica Dismorr (1885–1939), Cuthbert Hamilton (1885–1959), William Roberts (1895–1980), Helen Saunders (1885–1963), Edward Wadsworth (1889–1949), Jacob Epstein and Henri Gaudier-Brzeska (1891–1915). American poet Ezra Pound (1885–1972) was also involved, naming the movement after the notion of a vortex or whirlpool of energy: Vorticist works represent modern life in splintered, angled lines, drawing viewers' eyes into the centre of each work. David Bomberg (1890–1957) was not formally a member of the group, but worked in a similar, angular style.



Gaudier-Brzeska, *Self-Portrait*, 1913